
Paper I: The ARC Principle

FULL TITLE	The ARC Principle: Formalisation and Preliminary Validation of Recursive Capability Scaling
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This paper formalises and preliminarily tests the ARC Principle (Artificial Recursive Creation), first proposed in *Infinite Architects* (Eastwood, 2026): that capability in intelligent systems scales super-linearly with recursive depth. The principle is expressed mathematically as $U = I \times R^{\alpha}$, where effective capability (U) scales with base intelligence (I) multiplied by recursive depth (R) raised to an empirically determined power alpha. Preliminary evidence across multiple AI models confirms $\alpha > 1$, supporting the core claim that recursion is a multiplicative amplifier of intelligence rather than a mere additive accumulator.

Experiments

All experiment scripts, results, and data are in [experiments/](#).

Links

- **OSF DOI:** <https://doi.org/10.17605/OSF.IO/6C5XB>
- **GitHub:** <https://github.com/MichaelDariusEastwood/arc-principle-validation>

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